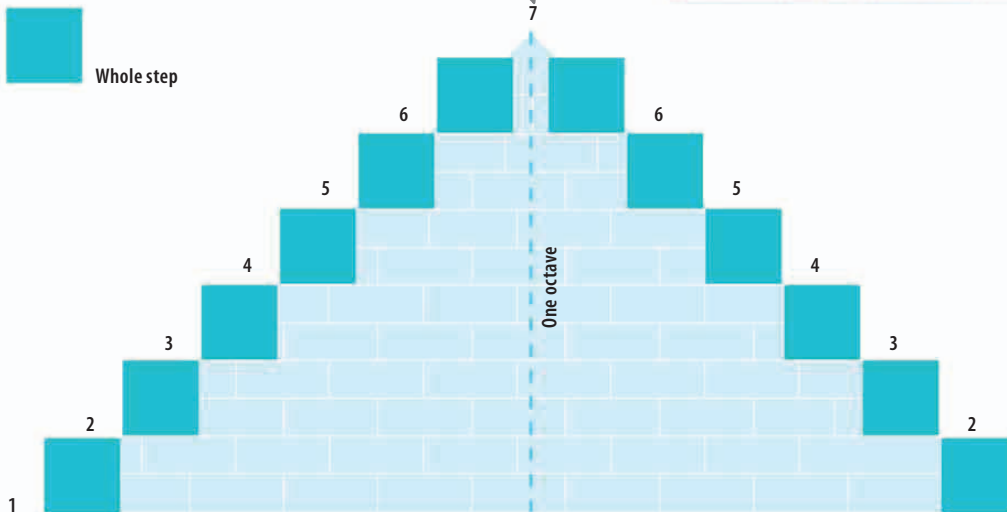


Whole step scales

A whole step scale also spans the range of one octave, but each note of the whole step scale is a whole step above or below the next one. This means that this scale includes seven notes in total, from top to bottom. It is broken down into six steps, and does not include any half steps.

The whole step scale rises through six whole steps to reach the top note, which is one octave above the starting note.



REAL WORLD

Claude Debussy (1862–1918)



Claude Debussy is the composer who is most closely associated with Impressionism, a style of music that makes extensive use of colorful harmonies and scales, other than the major and minor scales. Debussy often used whole step scales to make his music evocative and atmospheric.

◁ Whole step scale

Shown here is the whole step scale, broken down into six whole steps. Spanning the range of one octave, the whole step scale includes seven notes in all from top to bottom, each of which is one full step apart.

▽ On the staff

Shown here are some examples of whole step scales on the staff, one starting on C, and the other starting on E $\flat$. Each one is one whole step from the one before it.



Whole step scale starting on C

51



Whole step scale starting on E $\flat$

